

Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS) Services

A Comprehensive Guide to Core and Expanded Multi-Purpose Services under the Ministry of Cooperation

Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS) serve as the grassroots foundation of India's cooperative credit structure under the **Ministry of Cooperation**. To empower rural economies, PACS have been transformed into multi-purpose entities offering over 25 distinct village and banking services.

1. Core Financial Services

- **Credit and Loans:** Provide essential short-term and medium-term agricultural loans directly to farmers and rural borrowers while managing timely collection and repayments.
- **Banking Operations:** Function as the vital last-mile link connecting rural communities and individual borrowers with higher financial institutions, including NABARD, District Central Cooperative Banks (DCCBs), and commercial banks.

2. Expanded Multi-Purpose Services

- **Farm Inputs & Machinery:** Streamline the distribution of vital agricultural supplies such as high-quality seeds, fertilizers, protective chemicals, and modern farm tools or machinery.
- **Storage & Logistics:** Provide robust local crop storage infrastructure and actively participate in national grain storage initiatives to help minimize post-harvest losses.
- **Digital & Citizen Services (CSC):** Operate as Common Service Centres (CSCs) via the Digital Seva Portal, delivering more than 300 e-governance, financial, insurance, and utility services directly to rural citizens.
- **Retail & Fuel Distribution:** Diversify rural commerce by establishing retail stores, distributing basic healthcare supplies, and managing rural petrol, diesel, or LPG distribution outlets.

Note on Modernization

Over 152 major initiatives have been launched since the establishment of the Ministry of Cooperation. These initiatives have digitized traditional cooperative institutions, enhanced structural transparency, and unlocked brand-new avenues for local economic growth and operational diversification.

This is for informational purposes only. AI responses may include mistakes.